THE CANONICAL MAP FROM THE NORMALISED TO THE ASSOCIATED CHAIN COMPLEX IS SPLIT

THE STACKS PROJECT AUTHORS

Editorial note. The counted statement is the author's own lemma environment labelled lemma-decompose-associated-complexes (source lines 4032-4043); the proof environment begins on the second line after it and is its own proof, closing at source line 4113.

Editorial note. The proof invokes two author results of the same chapter by label; both are retained as context spans and the generator expands the context transitively (budget 800 lines for this card), while reference targets in other chapters that carry canonical project tags are auto-declared as non-load-bearing source pointers.

Editorial note. The retained preamble is the chapter's own minimal preamble (sources/stacks-simplicial/preamble.tex, taken with its real line count), a verbatim excerpt of the native Xy-pic setup, the native theorem declarations with the mathematical macros, and the project's own no-op reference environments; no macro was invented or redefined.

Editorial scope. One original result of the Stacks Project's Simplicial Methods chapter, counted once: the canonical morphism from the normalised to the associated chain complex is split, with a functorial complement.

Allowed standard prerequisites (editorial).

- Simplicial objects and the complexes N and s. For a simplicial object U of an abelian category, the associated chain complex s(U) with differentials the alternating sums of faces, and the normalised complex N(U) obtained by dividing by degenerate simplices.. They are the objects of the statement (source lines 4033-4036).
- Splitting of the canonical map on each degree. The subobject N(U_n) of U_n has a complement, by the author's splitting lemma and the definition of a split situation (retained as context).. It makes D(U)_n a legitimate complement on which the subcomplex claim can be checked (source lines 4052-4054).
- The simplicial identities. The relations between face and degeneracy maps, used here in the form d^n_i composed with s^{n-1}_j equals a degenerate composite, and the vanishing of the corresponding maps on N.. They settle the exceptional case m = n-1 of the induction (source lines 4100-4112).

Lemma 0.1. *Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category. Let U be a simplicial object in $\mathcal{A}$. Then U has a splitting obtained by taking $N(U_0) = U_0$ and for $m \geq 1$ taking*

$$N(U_m) = \bigcap\nolimits_{i=0}^{m-1} \mathrm{Ker}(d_i^m).$$

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Moreover, this splitting is functorial on the category of simplicial objects of $\mathcal{A}$.

Proof. For any object A of $\mathcal{A}$ we obtain a simplicial abelian group $\mathrm{Mor}_{\mathcal{A}}(A, U)$. Each of these are canonically split by Lemma 0.4. Moreover,

$$N(\mathrm{Mor}_{\mathcal{A}}(A, U_m)) = \bigcap\nolimits_{i=0}^{m-1} \mathrm{Ker}(d_i^m) = \mathrm{Mor}_{\mathcal{A}}(A, N(U_m)).$$

Hence we see that the morphism (0.2.1) becomes an isomorphism after applying the functor $\mathrm{Mor}_{\mathcal{A}}(A, -)$ for any object of $\mathcal{A}$. Hence it is an isomorphism by the Yoneda lemma. □

Definition 0.2. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category which admits finite nonempty coproducts. We say a simplicial object U of $\mathcal{C}$ is *split* if there exist subobjects $N(U_m)$ of U_m, $m \geq 0$ with the property that

$$\coprod\nolimits_{\varphi:[n]\to[m] \text{ surjective}} N(U_m) \longrightarrow U_n \tag{0.2.1}$$

is an isomorphism for all $n \geq 0$. If U is an r-truncated simplicial object of $\mathcal{C}$ then we say U is *split* if there exist subobjects $N(U_m)$ of U_m, $r \geq m \geq 0$ with the property that (0.2.1) is an isomorphism for $r \geq n \geq 0$.

Remark 0.3. By abuse of notation we sometimes write $d_i : U_n \to U_{n-1}$ instead of d_i^n, and similarly for $s_i : U_n \to U_{n+1}$. The relations among the morphisms d_i^n and s_i^n may be expressed as follows:

(1) If $i < j$, then $d_i \circ d_j = d_{j-1} \circ d_i$.
(2) If $i < j$, then $d_i \circ s_j = s_{j-1} \circ d_i$.
(3) We have $\mathrm{id} = d_j \circ s_j = d_{j+1} \circ s_j$.
(4) If $i > j + 1$, then $d_i \circ s_j = s_j \circ d_{i-1}$.
(5) If $i \leq j$, then $s_i \circ s_j = s_{j+1} \circ s_i$.

This means that whenever the compositions on both the left and the right are defined then the corresponding equality should hold.

Lemma 0.4. *Let U be a simplicial abelian group. Then U has a splitting obtained by taking $N(U_0) = U_0$ and for $m \geq 1$ taking*

$$N(U_m) = \bigcap\nolimits_{i=0}^{m-1} \mathrm{Ker}(d_i^m).$$

Moreover, this splitting is functorial on the category of simplicial abelian groups.

Proof. By induction on n we will show that the choice of $N(U_m)$ in the lemma guarantees that (0.2.1) is an isomorphism for $m \leq n$. This is clear for $n = 0$. In the rest of this proof we are going to drop the superscripts from the maps d_i and s_i in order to improve readability. We will also repeatedly use the relations from Remark 0.3.

First we make a general remark. For $0 \leq i \leq m$ and $z \in U_m$ we have $d_i(s_i(z)) = z$. Hence we can write any $x \in U_{m+1}$ uniquely as $x = x' + x''$ with $d_i(x') = 0$ and $x'' \in \mathrm{Im}(s_i)$ by taking $x' = (x - s_i(d_i(x)))$ and $x'' = s_i(d_i(x))$. Moreover, the element $z \in U_m$ such that $x'' = s_i(z)$ is unique because s_i is injective.

Here is a procedure for decomposing any $x \in U_{n+1}$. First, write $x = x_0 + s_0(z_0)$ with $d_0(x_0) = 0$. Next, write $x_0 = x_1 + s_1(z_1)$ with $d_1(x_1) = 0$. Continue like this

to get

$$\begin{aligned} x &= x_0 + s_0(z_0), \\ x_0 &= x_1 + s_1(z_1), \\ x_1 &= x_2 + s_2(z_2), \\ \ldots &\quad \ldots \quad \ldots \\ x_{n-1} &= x_n + s_n(z_n) \end{aligned}$$

where $d_i(x_i) = 0$ for all $i = n, \ldots, 0$. By our general remark above all of the x_i and z_i are determined uniquely by x. We claim that $x_i \in \mathrm{Ker}(d_0) \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_1) \cap \ldots \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_i)$ and $z_i \in \mathrm{Ker}(d_0) \cap \ldots \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_{i-1})$ for $i = n, \ldots, 0$. Here and in the following an empty intersection of kernels indicates the whole space; i.e., the notation $z_0 \in \mathrm{Ker}(d_0) \cap \ldots \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_{i-1})$ when $i = 0$ means $z_0 \in U_n$ with no restriction.

We prove this by ascending induction on i. It is clear for $i = 0$ by construction of x_0 and z_0. Let us prove it for $0 < i \leq n$ assuming the result for $i-1$. First of all we have $d_i(x_i) = 0$ by construction. So pick a j with $0 \leq j < i$. We have $d_j(x_{i-1}) = 0$ by induction. Hence

$$0 = d_j(x_{i-1}) = d_j(x_i) + d_j(s_i(z_i)) = d_j(x_i) + s_{i-1}(d_j(z_i)).$$

The last equality by the relations of Remark 0.3. These relations also imply that $d_{i-1}(d_j(x_i)) = d_j(d_i(x_i)) = 0$ because $d_i(x_i) = 0$ by construction. Then the uniqueness in the general remark above shows the equality $0 = x' + x'' = d_j(x_i) + s_{i-1}(d_j(z_i))$ can only hold if both terms are zero. We conclude that $d_j(x_i) = 0$ and by injectivity of s_{i-1} we also conclude that $d_j(z_i) = 0$. This proves the claim.

The claim implies we can uniquely write

$$x = s_0(z_0) + s_1(z_1) + \ldots + s_n(z_n) + x_n$$

with $x_n \in N(U_{n+1})$ and $z_i \in \mathrm{Ker}(d_0) \cap \ldots \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_{i-1})$. We can reformulate this as saying that we have found a direct sum decomposition

$$U_{n+1} = N(U_{n+1}) \oplus \bigoplus\nolimits_{i=0}^{i=n} s_i\Big(\mathrm{Ker}(d_0) \cap \ldots \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_{i-1})\Big)$$

with the property that

$$\mathrm{Ker}(d_0) \cap \ldots \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_j) = N(U_{n+1}) \oplus \bigoplus\nolimits_{i=j+1}^{i=n} s_i\Big(\mathrm{Ker}(d_0) \cap \ldots \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_{i-1})\Big)$$

for $j = 0, \ldots, n$. The result follows from this statement as follows. Each of the z_i in the expression for x can be written uniquely as

$$z_i = s_i(z'_{i,i}) + \ldots + s_{n-1}(z'_{i,n-1}) + z_{i,0}$$

with $z_{i,0} \in N(U_n)$ and $z'_{i,j} \in \mathrm{Ker}(d_0) \cap \ldots \cap \mathrm{Ker}(d_{j-1})$. The first few steps in the decomposition of z_i are zero because z_i already is in the kernel of $d_0, \ldots, d_i$. This in turn uniquely gives

$$x = x_n + s_0(z_{0,0}) + s_1(z_{1,0}) + \ldots + s_n(z_{n,0}) + \sum\nolimits_{0 \leq i \leq j \leq n-1} s_i(s_j(z'_{i,j})).$$

Continuing in this fashion we see that we in the end obtain a decomposition of x as a sum of terms of the form

$$s_{i_1} s_{i_2} \ldots s_{i_k}(z)$$

with $0 \leq i_1 \leq i_2 \leq \ldots \leq i_k \leq n-k+1$ and $z \in N(U_{n+1-k})$. This is exactly the required decomposition, because any surjective map $[n+1] \to [n+1-k]$ can be uniquely expressed in the form

$$\sigma_{i_k}^{n-k} \ldots \sigma_{i_2}^{n-1} \sigma_{i_1}^{n}$$

with $0 \leq i_1 \leq i_2 \leq \ldots \leq i_k \leq n-k+1$. □

Lemma 0.5. *Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category. Let U be a simplicial object of $\mathcal{A}$. The canonical morphism of chain complexes $N(U) \to s(U)$ is split. In fact,*

$$s(U) = N(U) \oplus D(U)$$

for some complex $D(U)$. The construction $U \mapsto D(U)$ is functorial.

Proof. Define $D(U)_n$ to be the image of

$$\bigoplus\nolimits_{\varphi:[n]\to[m] \text{ surjective},\ m<n} N(U_m) \xrightarrow{\bigoplus U(\varphi)} U_n$$

which is a subobject of U_n complementary to $N(U_n)$ according to Lemma 0.1 and Definition 0.2. We show that $D(U)$ is a subcomplex. Pick a surjective map $\varphi : [n] \to [m]$ with $m < n$ and consider the composition

$$N(U_m) \xrightarrow{U(\varphi)} U_n \xrightarrow{d_n} U_{n-1}.$$

This composition is the sum of the maps

$$N(U_m) \xrightarrow{U(\varphi \circ \delta_i^n)} U_{n-1}$$

with sign $(-1)^i$, $i = 0, \ldots, n$.

First we will prove by ascending induction on m, $0 \leq m < n-1$ that all the maps $U(\varphi \circ \delta_i^n)$ map $N(U_m)$ into $D(U)_{n-1}$. (The case $m = n-1$ is treated below.) Whenever the map $\varphi \circ \delta_i^n : [n-1] \to [m]$ is surjective then the image of $N(U_m)$ under $U(\varphi \circ \delta_i^n)$ is contained in $D(U)_{n-1}$ by definition. If $\varphi \circ \delta_i^n : [n-1] \to [m]$ is not surjective, set $j = \varphi(i)$ and observe that i is the unique index whose image under φ is j. We may write $\varphi \circ \delta_i^n = \delta_j^m \circ \psi \circ \delta_i^n$ for some $\psi : [n-1] \to [m-1]$. Hence $U(\varphi \circ \delta_i^n) = U(\psi \circ \delta_i^n) \circ d_j^m$ which is zero on $N(U_m)$ unless $j = m$. If $j = m$, then $d_m^m(N(U_m)) \subset N(U_{m-1})$ and hence $U(\varphi \circ \delta_i^n)(N(U_m)) \subset U(\psi \circ \delta_i^n)(N(U_{m-1}))$ and we win by induction hypothesis.

To finish proving that $D(U)$ is a subcomplex we still have to deal with the composition

$$N(U_m) \xrightarrow{U(\varphi)} U_n \xrightarrow{d_n} U_{n-1}.$$

in case $m = n-1$. In this case $\varphi = \sigma_j^{n-1}$ for some $0 \leq j \leq n-1$ and $U(\varphi) = s_j^{n-1}$. Thus the composition is given by the sum

$$\sum (-1)^i d_i^n \circ s_j^{n-1}$$

Recall from Remark 0.3 that $d_j^n \circ s_j^{n-1} = d_{j+1}^n \circ s_j^{n-1} = \mathrm{id}$ and these drop out because the corresponding terms have opposite signs. The map $d_n^n \circ s_j^{n-1}$, if $j < n-1$, is equal to $s_j^{n-2} \circ d_{n-1}^{n-1}$. Since d_{n-1}^{n-1} maps $N(U_{n-1})$ into $N(U_{n-2})$, we see that the image $d_n^n(s_j^{n-1}(N(U_{n-1}))$ is contained in $s_j^{n-2}(N(U_{n-2}))$ which is contained in $D(U_{n-1})$ by definition. For all other combinations of (i, j) we have either $d_i^n \circ s_j^{n-1} =$

$s_{j-1}^{n-2} \circ d_i^{n-1}$ (if $i < j$), or $d_i^n \circ s_j^{n-1} = s_j^{n-2} \circ d_{i-1}^{n-1}$ (if $n > i > j+1$) and in these cases the map is zero because of the definition of $N(U_{n-1})$. $\square$